

The Merchant and the Ant

Wang Sun was a **fabulously** wealthy merchant. But he wasn't **born with a silver spoon in his mouth**. For years he struggled, battling **poverty** and **creditors**, **dealing with** clients and suppliers and bankers and **skeptics**.

He became rich, slowly and **steadily**. He now had a **magnificent** home, carriages, and **wore** garments and jewellery fit for a king.

One day, he heard that all his ships were lost at sea. Wang Sun had raised a lot of money from moneylenders and banks to **outfit** his ships for trade, and overnight, he lost everything to his creditors.

His home, his carriages, his magnificent garments and jewellery, his servants and assistants, all disappeared as **mist** before the sunlight

Wang Sun was now a **broken** man. "What shall I do, he **wailed**, "I have lost everything. I cannot go on anymore. Let me kill myself.

His wife, who was a very **determined** woman, said, "You shall do nothing **of the sort**. We will visit the **wise** old **sage** who lives amongst the hills. People say he understands the ways of nature and the ways of man very well. Let us ask him for advice and see what he says"

"Is he a money lender? Is he a merchant?" said Wang Sun as he followed his wife up the hill. "How can he help me?"

When the Wise Man of the Hills heard Wang Sun's story, he laughed loud and long. Then he said, "Watch."

He took a **handful of** sand and threw it over an ant **crawling** at his feet. The ant, after a brief struggle, came up out of the sand and again started about his business. The Wise Man again threw a **heap** of sand on the ant. The ant again struggled for a long time, then finally **poked its head out** of the heap of sand.



"No matter how many times I throw sand over this little fellow, he will struggle out of the heap and **go about** his business of collecting food. That is his nature. What is your nature, Wang Sun, my boy? You have struggled to reach a position of great wealth and power, but you let only one heap of sand defeat you? The ant does not understand **adversity** and defeat, no matter how many times it comes to him. He does what nature meant him to do. Are you a merchant by nature, Wang Sun? Then go, follow your nature and don't come crying to me with little things."

Wang Sun went back to the city with renewed hope. **In time**, he became rich again for he had discovered his nature. He never forgot the Wise Old Man of the Hills, whose name was Confucius.

@mocks_wallah

Vocabulary

1. **Merchant** (noun) – trader, dealer, vendor, seller, businessperson – व्यापारी
2. **Fabulously** (adverb) – wonderfully, incredibly, fantastically, astonishingly, magnificently – आश्चर्यजनक रूप से
3. **Born with a silver spoon in one's mouth** (phrase) – born into wealth, privileged from birth, rich by birth, born in luxury, born fortunate – अमीरी में जन्म लेना
4. **Poverty** (noun) – destitution, lack, scarcity, need, penury – गरीबी
5. **Creditor** (noun) – lender, financier, moneylender, claimant, investor – ऋणदाता
6. **Deal with** (phrasal verb) – handle, manage, cope with, tackle, address – निपटना / सामना करना
7. **Skeptics** (noun) – doubters, disbelievers, cynics, questioners, unbelievers – संदेह करने वाले लोग
8. **Steadily** (adverb) – gradually, consistently, continuously, firmly, reliably – लगातार
9. **Magnificent** (adjective) – splendid, grand, glorious, majestic, luxurious – भव्य
10. **Wear** (verb) – put on, dress in, adorn, have on, clothe oneself – पहनना
11. **Outfit** (verb) – equip, furnish, supply, gear up, arm – सुसज्जित करना
12. **Mist** (noun) – fog, haze, vapor, cloud, drizzle – धुंध
13. **Broken** (adjective) – devastated, ruined, crushed, shattered, hopeless – टूटा हुआ / हताश
14. **Wail** (verb) – cry, weep, sob, lament, howl – विलाप करना
15. **Determined** (adjective) – resolute, firm, persistent, unwavering, strong-willed – दृढ़ निश्चयी
16. **Of the sort** (phrase) – of that kind, like that, similar, of such nature, such a thing – उस प्रकार का
17. **Wise** (adjective) – intelligent, knowledgeable, insightful, prudent, thoughtful – बुद्धिमान
18. **Sage** (noun) – wise man, seer, philosopher, guru, thinker – ज्ञानी पुरुष / ऋषि
19. **A handful of** (phrase) – a small quantity, a few, a small number, limited amount, some – मुट्ठी भर
20. **Crawl** (verb) – creep, inch, move slowly, slither, wriggle – रेंगना
21. **Heap** (noun) – pile, mound, stack, bunch, mass – ढेर

22. **Poke one's head out of something** (phrase)
– emerge, appear, come out slightly, peek
out, stick out – सिर बाहर निकालना

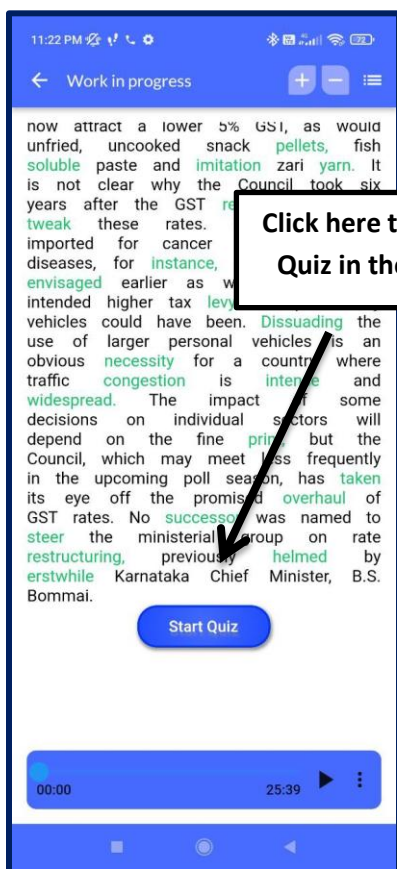
23. **Go about** (phrasal verb) – continue, carry
on, proceed with, pursue, engage in – काम
में लग जाना

24. **Adversity** (noun) – hardship, misfortune,
difficulty, trouble, calamity – विपत्ति /
कठिनाई

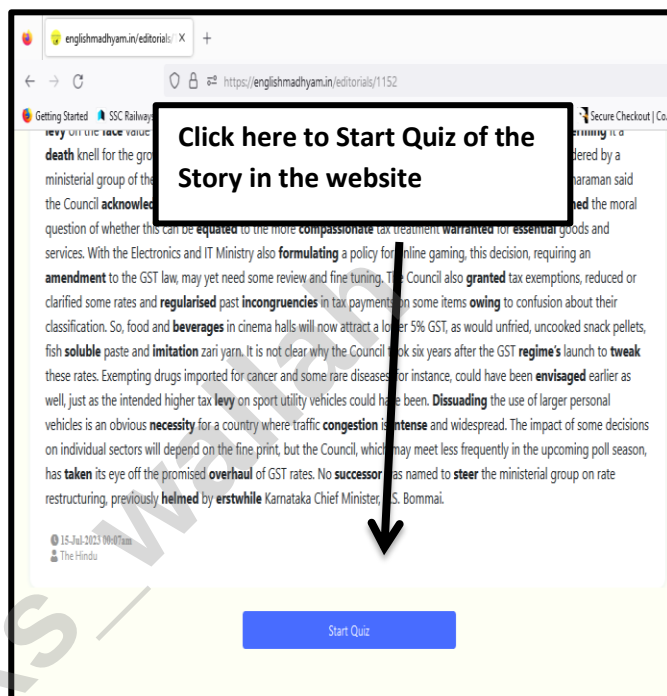
25. **In time** (phrase) – eventually, sooner or
later, ultimately, in the end, after a while –
समय के साथ

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Practice Exercise



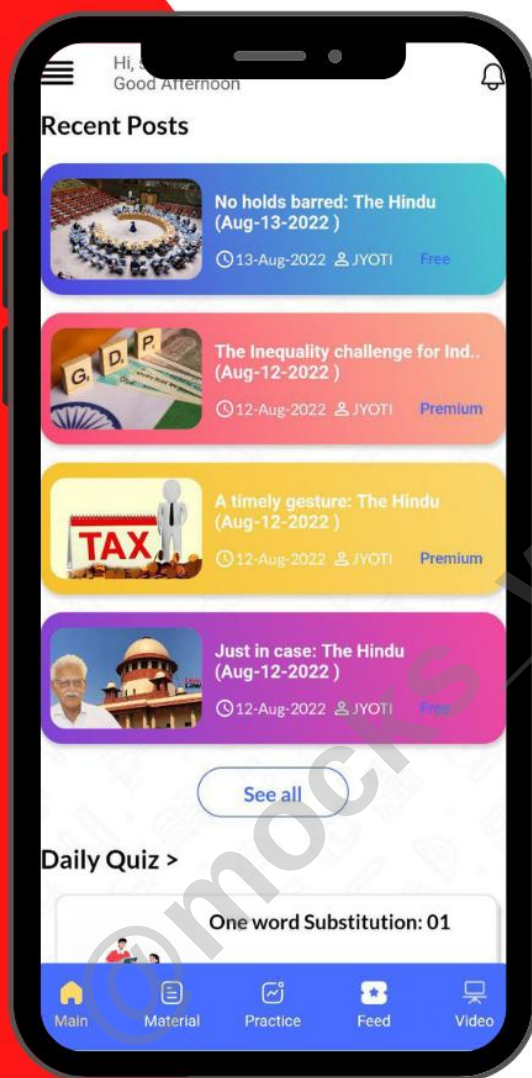
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